

Betrothy: One-Page Summary

The full thesis is in [market-research.md](#), the Africa deep dive in [africa-market-research.md](#), and the model in [market-sizing-model.md](#). Market figures are directional.

Betrothy is a community, with the tools and resources, to help with the transition from relationship to engagement, to marriage, and beyond. From the moment two people fall in love, through the wedding, and across the years that follow, Betrothy stands beside couples so no one has to navigate it alone. “This could be your love story.”

The problem

Love is the most important thing most people build, yet they build it largely alone. Couples navigate the biggest milestones of their lives, committing, getting married, and growing a life together, with fragmented tools and almost no community. The support that exists is transactional, and it ends the day after the wedding. Fewer people even reach marriage: fewer than half of US households are now married-couple households, one in four forty-year-olds have never married, and only about one in six adults say marriage is essential to a fulfilling life.

The solution

A community, with the tools and resources, to help with every stage, from relationship to engagement, to marriage, and beyond:

- **Grow in love:** a shared space and creative tools, including a custom sung song from the couple’s own story.
- **Commit:** an AI ring designer, plus the encouragement and support to move from a relationship to marriage with confidence.
- **Celebrate (the centerpiece):** a conversational planning companion that builds the plan, budget, vendor shortlist, and wedding page, with a gown studio, a registry, and a guest experience that brings everyone in.
- **Love that lasts:** after the wedding, a community and a growing set of tools to keep couples close, with shared experiences, trips, events, and date nights, through every anniversary and milestone.

No couple has to navigate it alone.

Why now

AI can finally handle the demanding work (planning a wedding by conversation, creating a custom song), exactly as couples want depth and meaning over templates. The old tools are transactional and stop at the wedding, which leaves the most valuable part, the lasting love story, unaddressed. Research backs the thesis: couples who keep up regular date nights are about 14% less likely to consider divorce.

Why it wins (the moat)

The **community loop**. Every wedding brings roughly a hundred emotionally engaged people into a love story at near-zero marginal cost, and they become the next couples, guests, and supporters. The story's joy and data compound across stages (the shared space knows the couple, the planner knows the taste and budget, the registry knows the people). Point tools cannot assemble this after the fact.

Market (the love and celebration economy)

Anchored by the US wedding category (about 2.0M weddings a year, average spend around 31k to 35k USD, roughly a 65 to 70B USD annual market), alongside the wedding and anniversary gift market (about 21B USD, shifting to personalized and experiential) and the fast-growing relationship-apps-for-couples market (about 0.85B to 2B USD, growing 13 to 17% a year). The near-term wedge is the high-intent wedding; the long-term prize is the wedding spend plus a lifetime of celebration.

Business model

1. **AI credits:** packs (5 to 20 USD) or 15 USD per month; billed at about 2x provider cost, roughly 50% gross margin; first generation free.
2. **Registry cash gifts:** 0.9% platform fee via Stripe Connect.
3. **Vendor marketplace (next):** subscriptions and featured placement, then a booking take-rate and payments. Plus the forever surfaces (anniversaries, milestone gifting) over time.

Africa (the second market)

A strong fit: huge guest-heavy weddings, aso-ebi coordination as a native group-commerce wedge, cash gifting and diaspora funding as the norm, and mature mobile-money and Paystack rails the product can settle on. Entry is the **diaspora bridge** (couples planning and funding weddings back home), which serves the US beachhead and seeds Africa at once.

What Betrothy includes

Betrothy brings together the planning agent (web and a native iOS app), the custom-song / ring / gown studios, wedding microsites with registry and guests, a vendor marketplace, messaging, a warm community-rooted matchmaker, the credits-and-billing system with an AI-cost and margin dashboard, and Google and Apple sign-in.

Go-to-market

Win one metro deep (supply-first vendor onboarding, concierge the first couples), let every wedding bring its people into a love story, then expand city by city and into the diaspora corridor. North-star metric: weddings activated.

Founder

Andrew Akuaku earned his Master of Information Management and Systems from UC Berkeley's School of Information in May 2026. His final research project studied how Gen Z engages with AI in dating and romance, and what makes a connection feel authentic rather than transactional. That research is the foundation for Betrothy, a product built to help couples build toward marriage and a lasting life together, not to gamify it.

The ask

Raising \$150,000 on a post-money SAFE at a \$1,000,000 cap (about 15% to friends and family) to prove the community loop in the first metro. Use of funds: beachhead go-to-market and vendor onboarding, product and AI, the payments and forever surfaces, and the Africa diaspora bridge. [Milestones to the next round: activated weddings, early revenue, retention.]

Sources

Market figures are directional. Full citations are in [market-research.md](#) and [africa-market-research.md](#). Headline sources:

- US wedding cost and count: [The Knot](#), [The Wedding Report](#), [Zola via Axios](#)
- Wedding and anniversary gifts: [Global Growth Insights](#)
- Personalization trend: [WEDfluencer](#)
- Relationship apps for couples: [Market Reports World](#)
- Africa (weddings, payments, remittances, connection): see [africa-market-research.md](#)